

New Zealand — Student Visa & Study Abroad Guide

Updated: September 2026

Important: This is general educational information, not legal, immigration or financial advice. Visa rules, fees, financial thresholds, processing times and document requirements can change. Always verify the current official authority and institution requirements before applying.

Official immigration resources

Visa guidance: <https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa>

Immigration / study information: <https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa>

At a glance

Visa / route	Student visa
Common intakes	February and July are common; programme-specific dates vary.

Typical student visa pathway

1. Choose an approved education provider and programme.
2. Apply for admission and obtain the required Offer of Place.
3. Prepare tuition/funding, accommodation, insurance and other evidence required for the visa.
4. Submit the student visa application using the current Immigration New Zealand process.
5. Complete any requested health/character checks and review visa conditions before travel.

Common supporting documents

- Passport
- Offer of Place
- Tuition-fee evidence or payment evidence as required
- Funds/living-cost evidence
- Accommodation evidence where applicable
- Insurance evidence where required
- Health/character documents if requested

New Zealand: planning your study application

Admission and visa are separate decisions

A university offer does not by itself guarantee a visa. First confirm the exact programme admission conditions and deadline; then follow the current immigration route and evidence requirements for your nationality and circumstances.

Study planning checklist

- Compare university and institute programme content and employment pathways.
- Check tuition and living-cost estimates by city.
- Confirm English and academic requirements for the exact programme.

After arrival

- Complete provider enrolment and orientation.
- Maintain the conditions printed on the visa.
- Keep contact with the education provider for attendance and study requirements.
- Check work rights and other conditions on the current visa grant.

Before submitting your visa application

- Check passport validity and identity details.
- Use the latest official application form/process for your country of residence.
- Make sure names, dates and education history are consistent across documents.
- Keep copies of submitted forms, receipts, appointment confirmations and supporting evidence.
- Check whether documents need certified translation and whether originals must be presented.
- Review the exact visa conditions after grant before travelling.

Useful official links

- [Official visa guidance](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa) — <https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa>
- [Official immigration/study information](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa) — <https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas/visas/visa/student-visa>

ViaSphere counsellor checklist

Use this page as a preparation worksheet. The exact evidence depends on the student, programme, nationality and current rules.

Area	Check	Status
Course	Programme, duration, level and campus confirmed	■
University	Official programme/admissions page reviewed	■
English test	Accepted test and minimum section/overall scores checked	■
Academic documents	Transcripts/certificates and translations checked	■
Funds	Current official financial evidence requirements checked	■
Passport	Validity and personal details checked	■
Accommodation	Plan/evidence prepared if required	■
Insurance/health	Current requirement checked	■
Visa application	Current official route and forms checked	■
Arrival	Registration/orientation/travel plan prepared	■

Official-source rule

If this guide conflicts with an official immigration authority, embassy/consulate, university or testing-provider page, follow the current official source. ViaSphere should not be treated as the issuing authority for any visa or admission decision.